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6 DOs and DON'Ts in AI Adoption

Emanuele Fabbiani

DON'T

Assume licenses = adoption

Assume buying ChatGPT Pro means AI adoption.

Handing out seats is the easy part. Without onboarding, use-case discovery and a community of practice, most licenses go unused after the first week. Treat AI as an organizational change.

DO

Invest in training

Invest in training, early and often.

AI literacy compounds. Run weekly hands-on workshops, share use cases, and celebrate wins from non-technical teams. People who learn together keep discovering new value.

DO

Start with personal productivity

Start with personal productivity.

The fastest path to ROI is helping each employee save 30 minutes a day on email, documents, meeting notes and code. Quick wins build momentum and trust before you tackle complex workflows.

DON'T

Build what you can buy

Build general-purpose tools — just buy them.

You won't out-engineer Google or OpenAI on transcription, search, image generation or chat. Spend resources on what's truly proprietary: your data, workflows and customer context.

DO

Build ephemeral software

Build ephemeral software.

With Codex or Claude Code, everyone can build the tools they need — no IT ticket required. A single-use dashboard, a one-off scraper, a meeting-specific calculator: built in minutes, used once, thrown away.

DON'T

Use agents as chatbots

Use agents as chatbots.

Agents demand a mindset shift: from executor curating every step, to manager defining the outcome. Set the goal, frame the constraints, and let the agent work on your behalf.

Six heuristics for AI adoption in SMEs

DON'T

Assume licenses = adoption

01

DO

Invest in training

02

DO

Start with personal productivity

03

DON'T

Build what you can buy

04

DO

Build ephemeral software

05

DON'T

Use agents as chatbots

06

ABOUT ME

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Founder at xstream and Reaidy (both acquired by TeamSystem in 2025).

Professor in AI at the Catholic University of Milan; guest lecturer at PoliMI, EPFL and Politechnika Wrocławska.

PhD in Applied AI, with 9 peer-reviewed papers and 170+ citations.

Speaker at 40+ international conferences – AMLD Lausanne, PyData Berlin, Paris and Milan, Swiss Python Summit, Codemotion.

